

Portraits of Christ Series

CHRIST - THE LAMB OF GOD

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: 1 Peter 1:18-21 (PLACE
REFERENCE ONLY ON SCREEN) (NIV)

“For you know that it was not with perishable things such as silver or gold that you were redeemed from the empty way of life handed down to you from your forefathers, 19 but with the precious blood of Christ, a lamb without blemish or defect. 20 He was chosen before the creation of the world, but was revealed in these last times for your sake. 21 Through him you believe in God, who raised him from the dead and glorified him, and so your faith and hope are in God.”

INTRO: When we think of a lamb, many pictures come to mind:

- A meek, mild and gentle animal...
- A quiet and defenseless creature...
- An obedient and submissive being...
- A sacrifice slain on an altar...

In our text Peter declares that Jesus the Lamb of God was not just another ordinary lamb, but a perfect lamb *“Without blemish or spot.”* This lamb was *“Chosen before the creation of the world and has been revealed in these last times.”* The offering of a lamb for sin was not the result of a surprised God attempting to find a way to fix the blundering ways of a fallen race. The sacrifice of Jesus was actually preplanned: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Before the world was created...
- Before there was a human being...
- Before the first sin was ever committed...
- Before subsequent sins were committed...

This preplanned lamb was also counted as slain before the worlds were formed. Think of the extent of the love of a Holy God reaching down to fallen man. We cannot fathom His devotion, dedication, and love, as He preplanned His only begotten sons journey from heaven to earth for the purpose of death by crucifixion! All this for one reason, to redeem a fallen race!

It is most difficult for us to get our minds around the significance of a sacrificial lamb because we have never known or participated

(Thank God) in a sacrificial paradigm of worship.

Today I want to attempt to help make the Portrait of Christ as The Lamb of God clearer than it has ever been.

I. THE HISTORY OF THE LAMB...

I think it fitting, the first animal sacrifice in the Bible was offered by Jehovah Himself. Genesis 3:21 (CEV) *“The LORD God made clothes out of animal skins for the man and his wife.”* I find it very interesting that immediately after the fall, God killed some of the animals He had created to cover the nakedness (sin) of the fallen race. Adam and Eve made a vain attempt to cover themselves through their own efforts by sewing together fig leaves that they hoped would cover their nakedness. Seeing man’s futile effort at covering sinfulness, God provided covering by means of a sacrifice. Sin: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Has never been covered without a sacrifice...
- Is never covered without a sacrifice...
- Will never be covered without a sacrifice...

The animals being slain by Jehovah to cover the nakedness of Adam and Eve is a portrait of what Jesus would do for the entire human race! Mohandas Gandhi, said, *“A man who was completely innocent, offered himself as a sacrifice for the good of others, including his enemies, and became the ransom of the world. It was a perfect act.”*

Under the New Covenant, [we are required to be clothed by Christ rather than our own good works.](#) Galatians 3:27 (CEV) ***“When you were baptized, it was as though you had put on Christ in the same way you put on new clothes.”*** Here we have Jesus as the Lamb of God, covering our sinfulness.

In Genesis chapter four Abel offered animal sacrifices to the Lord of the first of His flock. Again, we have a portrait of Christ as the Lamb of God.

Abraham was constantly offering animal sacrifices for himself and his family, all of which were a type of what Jesus would as The Lamb of God! Nowhere is this picture more vivid than in Genesis chapter twenty-two when a ram took the place of Isaac upon the altar at Moriah. What [a picture of Christ as The Lamb](#)

of God! **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Isaac was a miracle son, so was Jesus...
- Isaac was an only son, so was Jesus...
- Isaac was an innocent party, so was Jesus...
- Isaac was a willing sacrifice, so was Jesus...

That's where the similarities end and the differences begin. Isaac and Jesus were different in the following ways: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Isaac was spared as a sacrifice; Jesus was made a sacrifice...
- Isaac was allowed to live; Jesus died...
- Isaac was rescued by a ram caught in a thicket; Jesus died at the will of His Father...
- Isaac continued to live a normal life; Jesus was resurrected as an eternal God...

Another great portrait of Christ as The Lamb of God is the Passover lamb in Exodus.

The Passover lamb:

- Had to be spotless... (Sinless life)

- Fed a strict diet over a prescribed period of time... (Doing the will of His Father)
- Became both a sacrifice and a meal... (Bread that has come down from Heaven)
- Was to be killed at exactly the right time... (At twilight – Jesus came to earth to die)
- The blood was to be applied to the doorway of their homes... (Nothing but the blood)

They were to consume the sacrifice:

- With their loins girded... (Sanctified life)
- With their sandals on... (Prepared to follow)
- With their staff in their hand... (Leave in haste)

The sacrifice of the Passover lamb became so personal that: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- It was first referred to as *“A lamb.”*
(Jesus was certainly a lamb among many lambs)
- It was then referred to as *“The lamb.”*
(Jesus was the exclusive Lamb of God)
- Finally it was referred to as *“Your lamb.”*
(Jesus is a personal Lord of Glory)

II. JESUS THE LAMB...

We have seen the Old Testament accounts of the foreshadowing of the Lamb but the New Testament presents to us a very clear picture of how Jesus fulfills every part of the lamb in sacrificial worship.

I find it very interesting that God chose to use a lamb as the representation of what His Son would become. **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** The reason it seems peculiar to me is because:

- A lamb is a very small animal... (God is big)
- A lamb is weak in the animal kingdom... (God is all-powerful)
- A lamb is not a very wise animal... (God has all wisdom)

The Scripture declares, God wanted to take the *“Weak things of this world and use them to confound the wise.”*

John the Baptist declared, *“Behold the Lamb of God that takes away the sins of the world.”* By employing the word *“Behold”* John the Baptist was pointing to something of immeasurable spiritual and eternal significance. He was

saying: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The Lamb of God is here...
- This Lamb is the Messiah...
- He will take away the sin of the world...

Until this moment, the best a lamb could do was to roll sin ahead for one year at a time.

Previous lambs could only cover sin up for a season! The blood of millions of sacrificial lambs could not forgive a single sin; just roll it forward looking like a giant snowball of sin in anticipation of the coming of the Messiah.

Colossians 2:13-14 (NASB) ***“When you were dead in your transgression, He made you alive together with Him, having forgiven us all our transgressions, 14 Having canceled out the certificate of debt consisting of decrees against us, which was hostile to us; and He has taken it out of the way, having nailed it to the cross.”***

The Old Testament offerings only covered sin for a time, like a credit card covering a debt, it only postpones the inevitable! Eventually someone MUST pay the debt in full!

Because of His sinless life, He alone was qualified to forgive sin. He took my sin away! Jesus paid the debt of sin that had been charged

to the max, and he cut the card up! (*Do visual of this*)

Psalms 103:12 (NASB) “*As far as the east is from the west, so far has He removed our transgressions from us.*” How far is the East from the West? One can start traveling east and continue forever without coming to the end of east! The same is true if he tries to find the end of west.

III. JESUS THE LAMB CHANGES EVERYTHING...

Consider what Jesus the Lamb has done for us, we were: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Thought of by Him before time began...
- Sought out by Him in eternity past...
- Fought for by Him on an old rugged cross...
- Brought to Him by the Holy Spirit...
- Bought by Him through a horrific death...
- Taught by Him through His Word...
- Caught by Him through a sanctified life...
- Wrought by Him as His very own bride...

Jesus the Lamb of God: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Gave His life for us...
- Gave His life to us...
- Lives His life through us...
- Delivers on eternal life with Him...

When one comes into relationship with Him, nothing about us remains the same. ***“Old things pass away and all things become new.”***

CONCLUSION:

The ancient lambs of Old Testament worship and sacrifice, point us to a day when A LAMB would do what they could never do. Jesus was the fulfillment of the types and foreshadows those lambs provided, and He accomplished everything they typified.

The very best the ancient lambs could ever provide was a stay of execution for sins committed, but this Lamb of God expunged the record and erased not only the offense, but also the penalty for the offence. This Lamb of God has taken the process one step further; He makes all things new! 2 Corinthians 5:17 (NKJV) ***“If anyone is in Christ, he is a new creation; old things have passed away; behold, all things have become new.”***

If we see, understand and accept the portrait of Christ as the Lamb of God, He will change everything about us!

Portraits of Christ Series
CHRIST - THE I AM

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TEXT: Exodus 3:9-15 (PLACE
REFERENCE ONLY ON SCREEN)

(KJV) *“Now therefore, behold, the cry of the children of Israel is come unto me: and I have also seen the oppression wherewith the Egyptians oppress them. ¹⁰Come now therefore, and I will send thee unto Pharaoh, that thou mayest bring forth my people the children of Israel out of Egypt. ¹¹And Moses said unto God, Who am I, that I should go unto Pharaoh, and that I should bring forth the children of Israel out of Egypt? ¹²And he said, Certainly I will be with thee; and this shall be a token unto thee, that I have sent thee: When thou hast brought forth the people out of Egypt, ye shall serve God upon this mountain. ¹³And Moses said unto God, Behold, when I come unto the children of*

Israel, and shall say unto them, The God of your fathers hath sent me unto you; and they shall say to me, What is his name? what shall I say unto them? ¹⁴And God said unto Moses, I AM THAT I AM: and he said, Thus shalt thou say unto the children of Israel, I AM hath sent me unto you. ¹⁵And God said moreover unto Moses, Thus shalt thou say unto the children of Israel, the LORD God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, hath sent me unto you: this is my name for ever, and this is my memorial unto all generations.”

Exodus 3:14 (PLACE REFERENCE ONLY ON SCREEN) (AMP) *“And God said to Moses, I AM WHO I AM and WHAT I AM, and I WILL BE WHAT I WILL BE; and He said, You shall say this to the Israelites: I AM has sent me to you!”*

INTRO: In our text Moses was tending the flock of Jethro his father-in-law, who was the priest of Midian. On the day in question Moses led the flock to the far side of the desert and came to Horeb, which is known as “*The mountain of God.*” At Horeb the LORD appeared to Moses in flames of fire from within a bush. To fully understand this passage of

Scripture we must first discover who is in the bush. When the voice from within the bush identifies Himself to Moses as ***“I AM”*** the original words used are:

- Ego – Meaning *“I or I myself.”*
- Eimi – Meaning *“I Am.”*

In scripture Eimi is often used alone and still means ***“I am”*** without emphasis, but when *“Ego”* is added as a prefix, the ***“I AM”*** is meant to be emphatic. Such is the case in the incident of the burning bush experience of Moses. This use of ***“I AM”*** is employed four other times in the Old Testament and each time the person being referred to, is none other than Jesus. (Isaiah 41:4; Isaiah 41:10; Isaiah 43:10; Isaiah 48:12)

Most Bible scholars would agree that the name Yahweh or Jehovah, as it is sometimes translated, would be the proper name of God. All other name’s ascribed to Him, including the compound names, provided further revelation of His character and His activity!

Jehovah, or Yahweh, occurs 6,823 times in the Bible! Most English translations of the Bible translate this name with the word LORD, in all capital letters. Conversely, Adonai (ownership)

is often translated Lord, using upper and lower case letters.

Easton's Bible Dictionary gives us the following insight into the name Jehovah, our English name for Yahweh: *“This name was held by the later Jews to be so sacred that it was never pronounced except by the High Priest on the Day of Atonement, when he entered into the most Holy place. “*

The Hebrew name in Hebrew means, *“To be and so implies the absolute existence of God!”*

I want us to look at the I AM in 3-D.

I. I AM WHO I AM...

Smith's Bible Dictionary describes the difference between Elohim and Jehovah, or the difference between LORD and Lord: *“While Elohim exhibits God displayed in his power as the creator and governor of the physical universe, the name Jehovah designates his nature as he stands in relation to man, as the only almighty, true, personal, holy Being, a spirit and ‘the father of spirits,’ (John 4:24) who revealed himself to his people, made a covenant with them, and became their lawgiver, and to whom all honor and worship are due.”*

In our text, Jehovah transitioned from just being the creator of the universe, to being a personal God with whom Moses would interact over the next forty years.

The sight of a bush that refused to be reduced to ashes, by a white-hot fire, intrigued Moses!

The visitor in the burning bush was about to change his life forever. The person in the bush was Jesus and He changes the lives of all who dare to dialogue with Him.

The LORD called to Moses out of the bush and Moses responded, “*Here I am!*” With Moses attention securely fastened on the burning bush, the LORD said four things: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- **Do not come any closer...** A mere mortal can only tolerate a portion of the presence of the great I AM! Nonetheless, we should get as close as possible.
- **Take off your shoes...** In Eastern culture this was a sign of respect! One cannot build a relationship with the LORD until they have developed respect for Him.
- **You are standing on Holy ground...** The ground became Holy because of the

presence of the great I AM! His presence creates holiness wherever it goes!

- Go deliver My people... The constant activity of God is that of deliverance! Paul said, *“He hath delivered... He doth deliver... He will yet deliver...”*

To this point in the life of Moses, Jehovah was little more than a God of History that he learned about when Jochabed rocked him on her lap while he was but a child! He knew that in the past Jehovah had: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Created and populated the universe...
- Called and equipped his ancestors...
- Saved and delivered the Hebrews...
- Protected and provided for the Israelites...

Yet, to Moses Jehovah was little more than a God of History! For many people God has never been more than a God of history!

He wants to be more to each of us than a God of history! Jesus declared Himself to be the God of seven distinct designations in the book of John: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- John 6:35 – *“I am the bread of life...”*

- John 8:12 – *“I am the light of the world...”*
- John 10:7 – *“I am the door of the sheepfold.”*
- John 10:11 – *“I am the good shepherd.”*
- John 11:25 – *“I am the resurrection and the life.”*
- John 14:6 – *“I am the way, the truth, and the life.”*
- John 15:1 – *“I am the true vine.”*

Jehovah engaged extreme measures in an attempt to become a God of the present to Moses, and He is doing the same for someone in this room today!

II. I AM WHAT I AM...

When God first identifies Himself in this passage, He does so in terms of His historic relationship to Israel’s forefathers. Exodus 3:6 (KJV) *“I am the God of your father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac and the God of Jacob.”* At this, Moses hid his face, because he was afraid to look upon God.

The same God, who had acted through the unmistakable power of redemptive grace in the past, was speaking to Moses in real time.

Moses knew the history; Yahweh had delivered them, cared for them and sustained them in the past. Moses was about to discover that a very personal God was going to use him to redeem His people from Egyptian captivity!

The fact that Moses was engaged in a conversation with Jehovah was off the chain in the mind of Moses. When the voice from the burning bush suggested that Moses would be used as an instrument of deliverance, Moses lost control of all reason!

Moses was not thrilled with the news that he was going to be a chosen vessel in the hands of the great I AM! Moses immediately objects and his objections were baseless:

- He proceeds to tell I AM how unworthy he is...
- He then proceeds to explain to I AM how incapable he is...
- He even suggests someone else might be a better fit...

Exodus 3:11 (KJV) ***"Who am I, that I should go to Pharaoh and bring the Israelites out of Egypt?"*** This question is wrong on a lot of levels but it is most certainly irreverent and

irrelevant: Irreverent – This question calls into question God’s judgment in His choice of Moses.

Here you have an example of the creation arguing with the creator! Really?

Have you ever found yourself in this position? Have you ever made excuses about your ability or inability? When we do this we are being irreverent! This questioning of God’s choice of laborers is couched in the mistaken idea that we can do God’s will and work in our own strength! No such thing is possible! **We must not only have the call of God, but the presence of God to do His work!** Moses said, ***“If your presence is not going with us, do not carry us up hence.”***

Irrelevant: Whom God calls He qualifies! When we are called by God to perform a certain responsibility, He has not chosen us because we are the sharpest knives in the drawer; He selected us because He intends to anoint us for His task! To argue with the call of God, based on perceived ability is irrelevant! His call is not dependent on natural ability or skill; it is based upon anointing and obedience!

Besides, His gifts and callings are without repentance! Romans 11:29 (Amplified Bible)
“For God's gifts and His call are irrevocable.
[He never withdraws them when once they are given, and He does not change His mind about those to whom He gives His grace or to whom He sends His call.]”

III. I AM WHO I AM GOING TO BE...

Have your children ever asked, “Mommy, where did I come from?” And you replied, “From God! They then ask, “Where did God come from?”

Ken Hemphill in his book “Names Of God” makes this statement: “When such a question is asked, it is obvious that we are thinking in a scientific fashion in terms of cause and effect. We have been taught that everything that exists had to have a prior cause. That is the point of the name Yahweh. **God is the uncaused cause!** **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** When God states that He is the ‘self-existing’ One, this means He is the first cause and before Him there was no other and after Him there will be no other. Life is found in Him. He is the first cause that you may have been searching for all your life!”

Moses suffered from a problem that continues to plague humanity. Until his rendezvous with Jehovah at the burning bush; He was only a God of history to Moses! **Jehovah will have little to no effect on our lives as long as we relegate him to historical time frame!**

We have no problem with the historical accuracy of the Bible, we believe:

- God created the world...
- God parted the Red Sea...
- God delivered the Three Hebrew Children...
- Jesus died on a cross for our sin...
- Jesus ascended from Bethany's launching pad...
- Jesus promised to return for individual believers...

This is all well and good but if that is as far as we go, we have placed God in a historical box!

Moses finished his interrogation of Jehovah with one final question: Exodus 3:13 (KJV)
"Suppose I go to the Israelites and say to them, 'The God of your fathers has sent me to you,' and they ask me, 'What is His name'

then what shall I tell them?" This question is both reverent and relevant! Moses finally placed his focus in the right place! His question suggests that if the person in the burning bush was who He claimed to be, He could bring His will to pass irrespective of the odds! This should be the focus of our attention as we grow in our relationship to God and attempt to do His will!

Notice God's answer to Moses: Exodus 3:14 (AMP) ***"And God said to Moses, I AM WHO I AM and WHAT I AM, and I WILL BE WHAT I WILL BE; and He said, You shall say this to the Israelites: I AM has sent me to you!"***

The name Jehovah or Yahweh declares that God is: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Personal
- Self-existent
- Unchanging

The name Jehovah or Yahweh is used consistently in passages involving God's revelation to man. There are no references that begin with, ***"Thus saith Elohim,"*** it is always ***"Thus saith Jehovah or Yahweh."*** This name

affirms that God not only exists but that He communicates with us!

The voice in the bush identifies Himself as “***I AM WHO I AM...***” This revelation of who He is declares: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- His divine nature...
- His divine character...
- His divine attributes...
- Him to be the God of History...
- Him to be the God of real time...
- Him to be the God of eternity to come...

Moses’ question and God’s response turns the attention from who Moses is, to who was promising to be with Moses!

Notice what the LORD say’s to Moses: Exodus 3:15 (KJV) “...***This is my name for ever, and this is my memorial unto all generations.***”

The LORD is telling Moses that the name of Yahweh is to be a memorial to all generations:

- Generations past...
- In real time...
- Generations yet to come...

But really, what is the significance of His memorial name that is to be remembered forever? The word **“Remember”** is more than a mental act of memorization, it means, *“To recall and then act accordingly!”* So when God says that all generations are to **“Remember”** Him as Yahweh, this means that **all who know God are to see Him as being present with them and to act accordingly!**
(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)

What should this look like in 2011?

- When all hell is breaking loose in our lives, we are to recall His name, realize He is with us and allow peace to rule 24/7!
- When all hope has been lost, we are to recall whose we are and allow hope to anchor us!
- When our faith has been attacked, we are supposed to recall who is with us then stand fast on faith!
- When our confidence has been shaken, we should remember whose we are and place confidence in His ability rather than ours!
- When defeat seems to be lurking at the door, we must get our eyes off the circumstances, remember that He is the

captain of the LORD'S host, and remain engaged on the field of battle until the victory comes!

The person that lives in the awareness that God is present at every moment will live a very different life from the person who is reliant upon his or her own ability!

CONCLUSION:

When reading the Word of God we should remember that when we see the name LORD (all caps) we are being instructed to ***“Remember”*** who God is; how He is present with us; and that He will never leave us alone!

The name Jehovah or Yahweh declares that God is: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Personal...
- Self-existent...
- Unchanging...

Isaiah 40:25-31 (CEV) ***“The holy God asks, “Who compares with me? Is anyone my equal?”²⁶Look at the evening sky! Who created the stars? Who gave them each a name? Who leads them like an army? The LORD is so powerful that none of the stars are***

*ever missing. ²⁷You people of Israel, say,
"God pays no attention to us! He doesn't care
if we are treated unjustly." But how can you
say that? ²⁸Don't you know? Haven't you
heard? The LORD is the eternal God, Creator
of the earth. He never gets weary or tired; his
wisdom cannot be measured. ²⁹The LORD
gives strength to those who are weary. ³⁰Even
young people get tired, then stumble and fall.
³¹But those who trust the LORD will find new
strength. They will be strong like eagles
soaring upward on wings; they will walk and
run without getting tired."*

Portraits of Christ Series
CHRIST
THE ANGEL OF THE LORD

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Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: Genesis 16:1-16 (**PLACE**

REFERENCE ONLY ON SCREEN)

(NKJV) *“Now Sarai, Abram’s wife, had borne him no children. And she had an Egyptian maidservant whose name was Hagar. ² So Sarai said to Abram, “See now, the LORD has restrained me from bearing children. Please, go in to my maid; perhaps I shall obtain children by her.” And Abram heeded the voice of Sarai. ³ Then Sarai, Abram’s wife, took Hagar her maid, the Egyptian, and gave her to her husband Abram to be his wife, after Abram had dwelt ten years in the land of Canaan. ⁴ So he went in to Hagar, and she conceived. And when she saw that she had*

conceived, her mistress became despised in her eyes. ⁵ Then Sarai said to Abram, “My wrong be upon you! I gave my maid into your embrace; and when she saw that she had conceived, I became despised in her eyes. The LORD judge between you and me.” ⁶ So Abram said to Sarai, “Indeed your maid is in your hand; do to her as you please.” And when Sarai dealt harshly with her, she fled from her presence. ⁷ Now the Angel of the LORD found her by a spring of water in the wilderness, by the spring on the way to Shur. ⁸ And He said, “Hagar, Sarai’s maid, where have you come from, and where are you going?” She said, “I am fleeing from the presence of my mistress Sarai.” ⁹ The Angel of the LORD said to her, “Return to your mistress, and submit yourself under her hand.” ¹⁰ Then the Angel of the LORD said to her, “I will multiply your descendants exceedingly, so that they shall not be counted for multitude.” ¹¹ And the Angel of the LORD said to her: “Behold, you are with child, And you shall bear a son. You shall call his name Ishmael, Because the LORD has heard your affliction. ¹² He shall be a wild man; His hand shall be against every man, And every man’s hand against him. And he shall dwell in the presence of all his brethren.” ¹³ Then she

called the name of the LORD who spoke to her, You-Are-the-God-Who-Sees; for she said, “Have I also here seen Him who sees me?”¹⁴ Therefore the well was called Beer Lahai Roi; ^[u] observe, it is between Kadesh and Bered.¹⁵ So Hagar bore Abram a son; and Abram named his son, whom Hagar bore, Ishmael.¹⁶ Abram was eighty-six years old when Hagar bore Ishmael to Abram.”

INTRO: In the Bible, names are significant. People were intentional in choosing the names of their children and the meaning of those names would often choose the trajectory of the life of the child! Names were chosen for a variety of reasons:

- A family name sake...
- A family occupation...
- A joyous occasion...
- A traumatic event...
- A great victory...
- A devastating defeat...

In our culture names are no big deal but titles are looked upon as very significant! Titles in our culture somewhat demonstrate the significance of names in scriptural context.

One common denominator between titles in our culture and names in the Old Testament is that the bearer has the power to honor or demean the title or name. Proverbs 22:1 (NKJV) “***A good name is to be chosen rather than great riches, Loving favor rather than silver and gold.***”

There are many Biblical and contemporary examples of individuals who have honored and demeaned a name. We will only have one name and we would do well to manage it responsibly.

In our Scripture text we have a very interesting story that has had a far-reaching impact; in fact, our current culture is being shaped by the conflict between the Hebrews and the Arabs. This story is really the initiation of two nations with bad blood between them.

The facts as stated in Genesis 16 are as follows:
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Sarai lost patience with the promise of God... Verse 2 “***The LORD has restrained me from bearing children.***”
- Sarai took matters into her own hands... Verse 2 “***Go in to my maid; perhaps I shall obtain children by her.***”

- Abram yielded to the wishes of Sarai...
Verse 2 *“Abram heeded the voice of Sarai.”*
- Abram and Hagar conceived a child...
Verse 4 *“He went in to Hagar, and she conceived.”*
- Hagar disrespected Sarai... Verse 4
“When she saw that she had conceived, her mistress became despised in her eyes.”
- Sarai blamed Abram... Verse 5 *“Sarai said to Abram, ‘My wrong be upon you! I gave my maid into your embrace; and when she saw that she had conceived, I became despised in her eyes.’”*
- Sarai wanted Abram to take her judgment... Verse 5 *“The LORD judge between you and me.”*
- Sarai wanted Abram to correct the situation but he was having none of it...
Verse 6 *“Abram said to Sarai, ‘Indeed your maid is in your hand; do to her as you please.’”*
- Sarai executed judgment without mercy...
Verse 6 *“Sarai dealt harshly with her.”*
- Hagar decided to flee rather than fight...
“She fled from her presence.”

This is where the story gets interesting! While Hagar was hiding from Sarai she has a close encounter of the God-kind! Hagar encounters an Angel, but not just any Angel; He is described as “*The Angel of the LORD.*” Four times in five verses He is referred to as “*The Angel of the LORD.*” Notice two very important things about these verses:

- The word Angel is capitalized... This is not always the case in Scripture!
- The word LORD is in all capital letters... This is not always the case in Scripture!

When the word Angel is mentioned, many pictures come to mind:

- Wings...
- Feathers...
- Long white robes...
- Fluffy white clouds...
- Creatures floating and flying...

The word “*angel*” means messenger or one with a word or message from God. “*LORD*” in Hebrew is translated to mean Jehovah or Yahweh. This is the primary name for God in the Old Testament. The Angel of the LORD is none other than Jesus.

When Jesus is referenced in the Old Testament it is a Christophany. A Christophany is:

- A visible manifestation of Christ in the Old Testament...
- A pre-incarnate appearance of Christ in the Old Testament...
- An Old Testament appearance of Christ as an angel in visible form...
- A Christophany can also be a post ascension appearance of Christ in the New Testament...

The acid test of a Christophany is: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The character assumes divine titles...
- The character assumes divine prerogatives...
- The character accepts divine homage...

A sampling of Christophany's in the Old Testament would include:

- The LORD walking in the Garden of Eden with Adam and Eve...
- The LORD appearing to Abram as Melchizedek, Priest of the Most High God...

- The Angel of the LORD appearing to Abraham and actually sitting in the tent door in the plain of Mamre...
- The Angel of the LORD appearing to Hagar by the well of Shur... (Genesis 16)
He told her to go home and serve Sarai!
- Jacob wrestled with the LORD the night before he was reunited with his brother Esau...
- The cloud by day and pillar of fire by night...
- The rock that followed them was Christ...
- Balaam's donkey recognized the Angel of the LORD more readily than did Balaam...
- The Angel of the LORD appeared to Gideon while he was threshing wheat in the winepress...
- The Angel of the LORD presented Himself to Joshua as the Captain of The Lord's Host...
- The Three Hebrew Children experienced the LORD as the fourth man in the fire...
- Daniel found the LORD able to smite lions with lockjaw...
- John the Revelator discovered the LORD as a divine visitor on Patmos...

What we have here is definitely a Christophany;
Jesus is the Angel of the LORD who is
dialoguing with the lowly maid, Hagar!

This is a very interesting conversation indeed.
Genesis 16:7-16 (NKJV) “The Angel of the LORD found her by a spring of water in the wilderness, by the spring on the way to Shur.”⁸
And He said, “Hagar, Sarai’s maid, where have you come from, and where are you going?” She said, “I am fleeing from the presence of my mistress Sarai.”⁹ The Angel of the LORD said to her, “Return to your mistress, and submit yourself under her hand.”¹⁰ Then the Angel of the LORD said to her, “I will multiply your descendants exceedingly, so that they shall not be counted for multitude.”¹¹ And the Angel of the LORD said to her: “Behold, you are with child, And you shall bear a son. You shall call his name Ishmael, Because the LORD has heard your affliction.”¹² He shall be a wild man; His hand shall be against every man, And every man’s hand against him. And he shall dwell in the presence of all his brethren.”¹³ Then she called the name of the LORD who spoke to her, You-Are-the-God-Who-Sees; for she said, “Have I also here seen Him who sees me?”¹⁴ Therefore the well was called Beer Lahai Roi;^l

observe, it is between Kadesh and Bered. ¹⁵ So Hagar bore Abram a son; and Abram named his son, whom Hagar bore, Ishmael. ¹⁶ Abram was eighty-six years old when Hagar bore Ishmael to Abram.”

I want to focus on three things about this conversation between Jesus and Hagar!

1. The Angel of the LORD knows where we are and who we are...
2. The Angel of the LORD knows what to do with our present difficulties...
3. The Angel of the LORD always rewards obedience with blessing...

I. THE ANGEL OF THE LORD KNOWS WHERE WE ARE AND WHO WE ARE...

Genesis 16:7-8 (NKJV) “*The Angel of the LORD found her by a spring of water in the wilderness, by the spring on the way to Shur. ⁸ And He said, “Hagar, Sarai’s maid, where have you come from, and where are you going?”*”

This is no ordinary, run-of-the-mill angel!
Hagar was fleeing for her life and dignity, and did not want anyone to know where she was!

This is a woman on the lam; I am surprised the Angel of the LORD could find her!

Verse 7 - “*The Angel of the LORD found her by a spring of water in the wilderness, by the spring on the way to Shur.*” Look closely at what is being said here, the Angel of the LORD found Hagar: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- By a spring...
- In the wilderness...
- On the way to a place called Shur...

Shur is a city located southwest of Palestine on the eastern border and is actually within the border of Egypt; the Israelites passed through the wilderness of Shur after crossing the Red Sea. The name Shur means “*A wall.*” Hagar’s life had hit a wall but the Angel of the LORD was about to turn it into a well!

In the most desolate time of Hagar’s life, the Angel of the LORD knew exactly where she was! Friend, there is no place to hide from the presence of the LORD! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** Psalm 139 (NKJV) “*Where can I go from Your Spirit? Or where can I flee from Your presence? ⁸ If I ascend into heaven, You are*

there; If I make my bed in hell, behold, You
are there. ⁹ ***If I take the wings of the morning,***
And dwell in the uttermost parts of the sea. ¹⁰
Even there ***Your hand shall lead me, And***
Your right hand shall hold me. ¹¹ ***If I say,***
“Surely the darkness shall fall^[a] on me,” ***Even***
the night shall be light about me; ¹² ***Indeed,***
the darkness shall not hide from You, But the
night shines as the day; The darkness and the
light are both alike to You.”

Let me assure you today, the Angel of the
LORD has installed a GPS in our lives:

- We belong to Him...
- We are His responsibility...
- We are constantly on His watch list...
- We will always receive His love and protection...

Henry Blackaby said, “*He has right to interrupt your life. He is Lord. When you accepted Him as Lord, you gave Him, the right to help Himself to your life anytime He wants.*”

The Angel of the LORD does not just know where we are, He knows who we are! Verse 8,
“He said, Hagar, Sarai’s maid, where have you come from, and where are you going?”
The Angel of the LORD called Hagar by her

name! Think of this, Hagar is sitting by a well in the wilderness, close to the city of Shur. She has more than likely never been to this place before and does not believe anyone could possibly know who she was! While she was getting rehydrated and drowning in self-pity, the Angel of the LORD walks right up to her and say's ***"Hagar, Sarai's maid, where have you come from and where are you going?"*** I think Hagar probably thought something like, *"Excuse me do I know you? How do you know me? Are you following me? Are you a stalker?"*

Have you ever been far, far from home and someone walks up to you and calls you by name? The first thought is, *"How do you know me?"* (My experience in a rest area in Michigan – I was surprised when a man walked up to me and called me by name – He happened to live in the town where I was a Pastor at the time)

This was about to become a defining moment in the life of Hagar! She was about to find out who she was, but better yet, whose she was!

Oftentimes our view of who we are becomes clouded by success or failure so let me help us

readjust our focus. We are: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- A holy nation...
- A royal priesthood...
- A chosen generation...
- Heirs of the eternal God...
- Joint-heirs with Jesus Christ...
- Peculiar people set apart for the purpose of God...

The Angel of the LORD also identified with her occupation and place of employment! The Angel of the LORD said, “*Hagar, Sarai’s maid.*” This let Hagar know the Angel was for real! There were probably many Hagar’s in the region and this could have been a lucky guess!

When He let her know what she did for a living, and who her employer was, everything changed! This let her know that this divine visitor knew more about her than she ever thought possible!

From time to time we may feel that the LORD has lost track of us but let me assure us; His eye is on us every moment of every day!

II. THE ANGEL OF THE LORD KNOWS WHAT TO DO ABOUT OUR PRESENT DIFFICULTIES ...

Genesis 16:8-9 (KNKJV) ***"The Angel of the LORD said, "Hagar, Sarai's maid, where have you come from, and where are you going?" She said, "I am fleeing from the presence of my mistress Sarai.""*** ***The Angel of the LORD said to her, "Return to your mistress, and submit yourself under her hand."***

Notice, the Angel of the LORD asks two questions and gives two directives
If He is who He claims to be, He is not searching for information but rather attempting to provoke thought on Hagar's part!

1) ***"Where have you come from?"*** The Angel of the LORD is attempting to show Hagar things were not as bad in the house of Sarai as she thought!

When Joseph's brothers leave Simeon in Egypt with the promise to take Benjamin to the Prime Minister (Joseph), Jacob said, ***"You have bereaved me: Joseph is no more, Simeon is no more, and you want to take Benjamin. All these things are against me."*** Allow me to

give you a life changing truth: All THESE things may be against us, but all THESE things are not ALL THINGS! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** There is a huge difference between these things, and all things! What Jacob did not know is that his favorite son was Prime Minister, and he was about to move to Easy Street!

Sarai may not have been Hagar's BFF but let me tell you, God had a plan for Hagar and Ishmael!

2) *“Where are you going?”* Much like Jonah of old, Hagar was on a journey of self-indulgence! Any journey of convenience or self-indulgence is a dead end street!

Hagar was not in Shur because the Angel of the LORD led her there; she was there because she was ticked at Sarai! Until she met the Angel of the LORD, she had no intention of going back to the home of Sarai!

The Angel of the LORD was attempting to get Hagar to see that her decision to bail would lead she and her child into great hardship!

Remember, **Jonah: (PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Went down to Tarsus...
- Went down to the lower part of the ship...
- Went down to the sea...
- Went down to the belly of the fish...

When one goes AWOL on God there is only one way to go; down!

3) ***“Return to your mistress.”*** I would give anything to see the look on the face of Hagar when the Angel of the LORD gave her this word! This was not the word she wanted to hear for sure! She had no desire to live with Abram or Sarai any longer, yet that was exactly what God was calling her to do!

Teresa of Avila said, *“I know the power obedience has of making things easy which seem impossible.”*

We do not always understand the mandates of the LORD, but His word is always right! The old song say’s *“the Lord knows the way through the wilderness. All I have to do is follow.”*

4) *“Submit yourself under her hand.”* The Angel of the LORD made an over-the-top statement here. He is not just saying, *“Go back home and do what you can to get along with the old bittie.”* The Angel is saying: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Bring your will under subjection to her wishes...
- Place yourself under her authority for whatever purpose is necessary...
- Let her know that whatever she needs you to do, you will do it with joy...

This is a very large slice of humble pie don't you think? Could she do this? Yes! We can do so as well! The Angel of the LORD never makes an impossible request!

III. THE ANGEL OF THE LORD ALWAYS REWARDS OBEDIENCE WITH BLESSING...

Genesis 16:10-16 (NKJV) *“Then the Angel of the LORD said to her, “I will multiply your descendants exceedingly, so that they shall not be counted for multitude.”¹¹ And the Angel of the LORD said to her: “Behold, you are with child, And you shall bear a son. You shall call his name Ishmael, Because the LORD has*

heard your affliction. ¹² He shall be a wild man; His hand shall be against every man, And every man's hand against him. And he shall dwell in the presence of all his brethren.”

For starters, this whole stinking situation was not the fault of Hagar:

- Abram went from Canaan to Egypt because of a famine... (He should never have gone – He was not there by the permission of the Lord)
- In Egypt, he started a legacy of lying for his children to follow ... (She's not my wife, she's my sister)
- While in Egypt he accumulated some things God never intended him to have... (Cattle – He was a shepherd – Sheep eat with their front teeth while cows eat with their tongues – This limited where Abram could travel - He was given man-servants, and maid-servants and this is where Hagar came from)
- Sarai came up with the idea of Abram and Hagar... (This was never Hagar's idea)

The Angel of the LORD made Hagar aware that even though she had been party to interfering with the plan of God, He would yet make of her a great nation!

Some people think that if they ever miss it, even once, they can never reach their destiny! This is not true! The Angel of the LORD is the master of taking what has been completely wrecked and making it into something beautiful! **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)**

Isaiah 61:3-4 (NKJV) ***"The Spirit of the LORD is upon me and has anointed me to give them beauty for ashes, The oil of joy for mourning, The garment of praise for the spirit of heaviness; That they may be called trees of righteousness, The planting of the LORD, that He may be glorified."***⁴ ***And they shall rebuild the old ruins, They shall raise up the former desolations, And they shall repair the ruined cities, The desolations of many generations."***

Thomas Kinkade said, *"When we learn to say a deep, passionate yes to the things that really matter... then peace begins to settle onto our lives like golden sunlight sifting to a forest floor."*

The promise of God to Hagar is more about Abram's seed than Hagar's promise! God had already pronounced a blessing upon the seed of Abram. Even though Sarai, Abram and Hagar

were way out of line, the seed of Abram in the womb of Hagar cried out for the fulfillment of the promise of God. There was such power in the promise pronounced over Abram's seed that God decided to make two nations instead of one!

CONCLUSION:

Genesis 16:13-16 (NKJV) ***"Then she called the name of the LORD who spoke to her, You-Are-the-God-Who-Sees; for she said, "Have I also here seen Him who sees me?"***¹⁴

Therefore the well was called Beer Lahai Roi; observe, it is between Kadesh and Bered.¹⁵ ***So Hagar bore Abram a son; and Abram named his son, whom Hagar bore, Ishmael.***¹⁶ ***Abram was eighty-six years old when Hagar bore Ishmael to Abram."***

1) The name Hagar means flight – This is exactly what Hagar was doing, running from her problem.

2) Hagar gave God a name – This is the first time but not the last time in scripture that this occurs! ***"The God who sees; I have seen Him who sees me."***

3) The well received a name – Beer Lahai Roi – Living or alive. (Remember, she is in the middle of the wilderness)

4) The child receives a name – Ishmael – God will hear.

5) Hagar receives a promise – The Angel of the LORD promised that Ishmael would become a great nation. Thousands of years later, it is obvious that the Angel of the LORD has kept His word! There are more than one billion descendants of Ishmael alive in the world today! The Angel of the LORD predicted Ishmael's seed would not be able to be numbered and it has surely come to pass!

The Angel of the LORD always keeps His promise!

In the middle of our most traumatic experience God is capable of seeing, hearing, and furnishing a table in the wilderness. If He did it for Hagar, He will do it for us!

Portraits of Christ Series
CHRIST - RABBI

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

TEXT: Matthew 23:1-11 **(PLACE
SCRIPTURE REFERENCE ONLY ON
SCREEN)** (NKJV) *“Then Jesus spoke to the multitudes and to His disciples, ² saying: “The scribes and the Pharisees sit in Moses’ seat. ³ Therefore whatever they tell you to observe, that observe and do, but do not do according to their works; for they say, and do not do. ⁴ For they bind heavy burdens, hard to bear, and lay them on men’s shoulders; but they themselves will not move them with one of*

their fingers. ⁵ Everything they do is just to show off in front of others. They even make a big show of wearing Scripture verses on their foreheads and arms, and they wear big tassels for everyone to see. ⁶ They love the best places at feasts, the best seats in the synagogues, ⁷ greetings in the marketplaces, and to be called by men, ‘Rabbi, Rabbi.’ ⁸ But you, do not be called ‘Rabbi’; for One is your Teacher, the Christ, and you are all brethren. ⁹ Do not call anyone on earth your father; for One is your Father, He who is in heaven. ¹⁰ And do not be called teachers; for One is your Teacher, the Christ. ¹¹ But he who is greatest among you shall be your servant.”

INTRO: Because most of us are not Jewish, it is difficult for us to fully embrace the meaning of Christ as the Rabbi.

Contextually, the word Rabbi appears in three forms in Jewish culture: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- **Rab** – Honored one. To the Jewish audience this is the first level of honor.
- **Rabbi** – My honored one or My Master. This is the next level of honor and dignity.
- **Rabboni** – My Great Master or the most honorable of all.

In Christian circles the minister is not revered with the same level of respect as a Rabbi in a Jewish tradition. (Board member who told me *“Preachers are a dime a dozen.”*)

I am certainly not demanding any additional respect; I believe a minister must earn it just like anyone else. However, there should be a initial level of respect that is granted to those who serve in a ministerial role, because of the office they hold in the Kingdom.

Jesus as Rabbi is a much more weighty subject than most of us realize. I would like to focus on three things about Jesus as Rabbi.

I. A RABBI IS A PERSON WHO IS WELL VERSED IN RELIGIOUS DISCIPLINES...

Every religion known to man has certain disciplines that are expected of its followers and adherents. Some of these expectations are unbelievably low and others are ridiculously high.

For instance, under the Law, the people were expected to keep the Law of Moses and the

rules set forth by the religious bureaucrats. The Law could be kept by a person who paid close enough attention and who had a strong will. The problem was that the religious bureaucrats kept inserting additional expectations until no one could follow the guidelines. Incidentally, the people who were writing the rules were found to be incapable of living up to their own expectations.

The bottom line is that **anything worth devoting a life to should have some benchmark expectations. (LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)** While the people under the Law were under such legalistic expectations, the current church world has become so loose and fast with their morals, there is little to no distinguishing traits that separate the Christian from the world.

Neither scenario is plausible!

Suffice it to say, if we are going to be Christ followers we must follow our Rabbi into a holy life. Hebrews 12:14 (NKJV) ***“Pursue peace with all people, and holiness, without which no one will see the Lord.”***

Charles Kettering said, *“High achievements always takes place in a framework of high expectations.”*

A Rabbi was a man skilled in the Law of Moses as well as the teachings of the Prophets, and who taught and trained others in such disciplines.

Each Rabbinical student was required to study under a Rabbi or a group of Rabbi's and therefore had a certain level of credentials and respect within society!

Of course the Rabbi we are going to discuss today is the foundation upon which our entire system of religion has been established.

Ephesians 2:19-22 (NKJV) ***“You are no longer strangers and foreigners, but fellow citizens with the saints and members of the household of God, ²⁰ having been built on the foundation of the apostles and prophets, Jesus Christ Himself being the chief cornerstone, ²¹ in whom the whole building, being fitted together, grows into a holy temple in the Lord, ²² in whom you also are being built together for a dwelling place of God in the Spirit.”***

1 Peter 2:3-8 (NKJV) *“If indeed you have tasted that the Lord is gracious. ⁴ Coming to Him as to a living stone, rejected indeed by men, but chosen by God and precious, ⁵ you also, as living stones, are being built up a spiritual house, a holy priesthood, to offer up spiritual sacrifices acceptable to God through Jesus Christ. ⁶ Therefore it is also contained in the Scripture, “Behold, I lay in Zion A chief cornerstone, elect, precious, And he who believes on Him will by no means be put to shame.” ⁷ Therefore, to you who believe, He is precious; but to those who are disobedient, “The stone which the builders rejected Has become the chief cornerstone,” ⁸ and “A stone of stumbling And a rock of offense.” They stumble, being disobedient to the word, to which they also were appointed.”*

II. A RABBI IS A WELL VERSED TEACHER...

While a Rabbi must fulfill some pretty strenuous, rigid requirements, **Rabbi Jesus is:**
(PLACE ON SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Omnipotent...
- Omnipresent...
- Omniscient...

This Rabbi is not just well versed in a system of religion, He was present and engaged when the whole thing was set into motion! John 1:1-12 (CEV) ***"In the beginning was the one who is called the Word. The Word was with God and was truly God. ²From the very beginning the Word was with God. ³And with this Word, God created all things. Nothing was made without the Word. Everything that was created ⁴received its life from him, and his life gave light to everyone. ⁵The light keeps shining in the dark, and darkness has never put it out. ⁶God sent a man named John, ⁷who came to tell about the light and to lead all people to have faith. ⁸John wasn't that light. He came only to tell about the light. ⁹The true light that shines on everyone was the light coming into the world. ¹⁰The Word was in the world, but no one knew him, though God had made the world with his Word. ¹¹He came into his own world, but his own nation did not welcome him. ¹²Yet some people accepted him and put their faith in him. So he gave them the right to be the children of God."***

This is not a disengaged Rabbi! He is not focused on a retirement contract or a benefits package! Rather than focusing on preparing one for respect and honor this Rabbi is interested in

shaping the heart; mind; and will of those who are following Him. Patricia Neal said, *“A master can tell you what he expects of you. A teacher, though, awakens your own expectations.”*

Rather than readying His followers for a seat of honor He is preparing us for a life of service!

Those who choose to follow this Rabbi should pursue Him and His teaching with an unrelenting passion. **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE)** Hosea 6:3 (The Message) *“We're ready to study God, eager for God-knowledge. As sure as dawn breaks, so sure is his daily arrival. He comes as rain comes, as spring rain refreshing the ground.”*

It is one thing to know about God, it is a completely different thing to know God! Jeremiah 9:23-24 (NIV) *“This is what the LORD says: “Let not the wise man boast of his wisdom or the strong man boast of his strength or the rich man boast of his riches. 24 but let him who boasts boast about this: that he understands and knows me, that I am the LORD, who exercises kindness, justice and*

righteousness on earth, for in these I delight," declares the LORD."

We must commit to following the Rabbi who has: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The words of eternal life...
- All the answers to life's questions...
- All the power for the difficult times...
- Perfect direction for the journey ahead...

III. A RABBI IMPARTS A LIFESTYLE TO HIS FOLLOWERS...

The primary function of a Rabbi was to impart a lifestyle! The prearranged, agreed to lifestyle was known as a "yoke" under which the student voluntarily placed himself.

We are under no compulsion to follow Him!
Rabbi Jesus' followers must do so by an act of their own will!

Each student knew that through listening to, learning from, and following a Rabbi they would acquire a treasure trove of knowledge about the Law of Moses and the teachings of

the prophets. Ideally, that knowledge would translate into a changed life pattern!

As we all know in studying Scripture the Rabbis were long on knowledge but short on assimilation. This fact is pointed out in our text in the following ways:

- They were big on saying but sorry at doing... (Vs.3)
- They loaded individuals down with heavy burdens but would not lift a finger to help... (Vs. 4)
- They had the outward appearance of strict adherence to the law, but it had not morphed into a lifestyle... (Vs. 5)
- They loved the attention the office of Rabbi carried but they were unworthy of such respect... (Vs. 6)

Rabbi Jesus did not place His focus on the law; He focused on transformation of the lifestyle of His followers. He transforms our lives with His truth! [George Orwell](#) who stood against Hitler and the Nazis' said, *"In a time of universal deceit, truth is a revolutionary act!"* (**LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLIDE**) For sure, Jesus was a very different sort of Rabbi than His Jewish audience was accustomed to!

This Rabbi not only instructs His student about a exemplary lifestyle, He also furnishes the power for the follow through! Acts 1:8 (NIV)

“But you will receive power when the Holy Spirit comes on you; and you will be my witnesses in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the ends of the earth.”

The life of Rabbi Jesus was a perfect prototype of the Spirit empowered life! The real measurement of the Spirit empowered life is the Gifts of the Spirit, which Jesus regularly functioned in, and the fruit of the Spirit, which He constantly exemplified:

- Love...
- Joy...
- Peace...
- Longsuffering...
- Gentleness...
- Faithfulness...
- Goodness...
- Meekness...
- Temperance...

Often there is a tremendous disconnect between the gifts and the fruit of the Spirit, but Jesus

constantly modeled both! If we are going to follow this Rabbi we MUST do no less!

The Book of Acts is the story of the disciples receiving what Jesus received in order to do what Jesus did! Acts 4:13 (NIV) ***“When they saw the courage of Peter and John and realized that they were unschooled, ordinary men, they were astonished and they took note that these men had been with Jesus.”*** Acts 5:42 (NIV) ***“Day after day, in the temple courts and from house to house, they never stopped teaching and proclaiming the good news that Jesus is the Christ.”***

CONCLUSION:

What is the end result of following Rabbi Jesus? Acts 6:7 (New International Version) ***“So the word of God spread. The number of disciples in Jerusalem increased rapidly, and a large number of priests became obedient to the faith.”*** **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- The Word of God is proclaimed throughout the world...
- Multitudes are added to the Kingdom of God...

- Rabbi's come out of the wood-work to join His cause...

WARNING TO ALL WOULD BE

RABBI'S: Rabbi Jesus never promised the path of follow-ship would be easy, He just assures all His little Rabbi's the grace will be sufficient!

The path of the first twelve disciples of Rabbi Jesus was not easy:

- Andrew died on a cross
- Simon was crucified
- Bartholomew was flayed alive
- James the son of Zebedee was beheaded
- James the son of Alphaeus was beaten to death
- Thomas was run through with a lance
- Mathias was stoned and then beheaded
- Matthew was slain by the sword
- Peter was crucified upside down
- Thaddeus was shot to death with arrows
- Philip was hanged
- Only John made it through alive but he was boiled in oil and exiled to a small island in the middle of the Mediterranean Sea

Our path may not always be easy but we can be assured, this street turns to gold. **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)**

Portraits of Christ Series
CHRIST – THE HIGH PRIEST

Blue denotes power point slide

Brown denotes instructions to technician

**TEXT: (PLACE SCRIPTURE
REFERENCE ONLY ON THE SCREEN)**

Hebrews 2:17-18 (NKJV) *“In all things He
had to be made like His brethren, that He*

might be a merciful and faithful High Priest in things pertaining to God, to make propitiation for the sins of the people. ¹⁸ For in that He Himself has suffered, being tempted, He is able to aid those who are tempted.”

[Hebrews 4:14-16](#) (NKJV) *“Seeing then that we have a great High Priest who has passed through the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our confession. ¹⁵ For we do not have a High Priest who cannot sympathize with our weaknesses, but was in all points tempted as we are, yet without sin. ¹⁶ Let us therefore come boldly to the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy and find grace to help in time of need.”*

INTRO: The Old Testament model of ministry was administered by and flowed through the office of the High Priest. Nothing happened in religious life without the fingerprints of the High Priest being imprinted on it. In the New Testament and beyond, Jesus is the High Priest.

We must remember the Old Testament was a model that was set forth for the purpose of revealing what religious life would look like when the Messiah finally arrived. So, quite

literally, every assigned task of the Old Testament High Priest was a type and foreshadowing of what Jesus would become to the New Testament believer. The only thing that would change is that Jesus would do everything far better than an Old Testament High Priest.

The book of Hebrews makes three major comparisons: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- How Jesus is like the Old Testament High Priest...
- How the New Covenant is like the Old Covenant...
- How the New Covenant is better than the Old Covenant...

Though Jesus is after the pattern of the Old Testament High Priest and the New Covenant is modeled after the Old Covenant, the book of Hebrews employs the word “*better*” fourteen times! The word “*better*” is used in the following ways:

- Jesus is made better than the angels...
(1:4)
- Better things are in store for believers...
(6:9)

- Jesus is better than Melchizedek... (7:7)
- Jesus offers better hope... (7:19)
- Jesus is a better guarantee of a better covenant... (7:22)
- Jesus delivers on better promises... (8:6)
- Jesus offered a better sacrifice... (9:23)
- Jesus reveals a better heaven... (10:34
11:16)
- Jesus makes available a better resurrection... (11:35)
- Jesus offers a better future... (11:40)
- Jesus is a better mediator... (12:24)

Before we get into the New Testament manifestations of Jesus as High Priest I want to point out one really significant fact about Him. Hebrews 1:1-4 (NIV) ***"In the past God spoke to our forefathers through the prophets at many times and in various ways, 2 but in these last days he has spoken to us by his Son, whom he appointed heir of all things, and through whom he made the universe. 3The Son is the radiance of God's glory and the exact representation of his being, sustaining all things by his powerful word. After he had provided purification for sins, he sat down at the right hand of the Majesty in heaven. 4So he became as much superior to the angels as***

the name he has inherited is superior to theirs.” The words *“exact representation”* were translated from the Greek word, *“charkacter”* and means *“a stamp or impression.”* The word was used in the first century to refer to the impression made by a seal or a die cut, like an engraving that makes an exact impression of a letter or a seal.

If you want to know what Jesus is like, He is exactly like His Father. Hebrews 8:5 (New International Version) *“They serve at a sanctuary that is a copy and shadow of what is in heaven. This is why Moses was warned when he was about to build the tabernacle: ‘See to it that you make everything according to the pattern shown you on the mountain.’”* Hebrews 8:5 (AMP) *“[But these offer] service [merely] as a pattern and as a foreshadowing of [what has its true existence and reality in] the heavenly sanctuary. For when Moses was about to erect the tabernacle, he was warned by God, saying, ‘See to it that you make it all [exactly] according to the copy (the model) which was shown to you on the mountain.’”*

**(PLACE SUSAN, LARISSA, AND RYLEES
BABY PICTURES ON THE SCREEN –**

ALSO PLACE JASON AND BRADEN'S BABY PICTURES ON THE SCREEN)

Jesus is a mirrored image of the Father! John 14:4-10 (NKJV) ***"Where I go you know, and the way you know."***⁵ ***Thomas said to Him, "Lord, we do not know where You are going, and how can we know the way?"***⁶ ***Jesus said to him, "I am the way, the truth, and the life. No one comes to the Father except through Me."***⁷ ***"If you had known Me, you would have known My Father also; and from now on you know Him and have seen Him."***⁸ ***Philip said to Him, "Lord, show us the Father, and it is sufficient for us."***⁹ ***Jesus said to him, "Have I been with you so long, and yet you have not known Me, Philip? He who has seen Me has seen the Father; so how can you say, 'Show us the Father'?"***¹⁰ ***Do you not believe that I am in the Father, and the Father in Me? The words that I speak to you I do not speak on My own authority; but the Father who dwells in Me does the works."***

We have a sovereign Lord who is our High Priest. He is the all-powerful Creator, worthy of worship by all His creation. Not only is He powerful, He is also good and righteous in every way.

I want us to look at this Jesus as High Priest in four different roles: **(PLACE ALL FOUR ON THE SCREEN AT ONCE)**

- Sacrificial High Priest...
- Sympathetic High Priest...
- Strong High Priest...
- Sovereign High Priest...

I. SACRIFICIAL HIGH PRIEST... **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE)**

The assigned duty of the High Priest in Moses Tabernacle was to usher the people into worship and to offer up sacrifices for the sins of the people. Jesus is our advocate. Hebrews 7:25 (NKJV) ***“He is also able to save to the uttermost those who come to God through Him, since He always lives to make intercession for them.”***

The Old Testament High Priest offered up animal sacrifices but in the New Testament, Jesus became the sacrifice. 2 Corinthians 5:21 (NKJV) ***“He made Him who knew no sin to be sin for us, that we might become the righteousness of God in Him.”***

The blood of the eternal High Priest was not just any blood; it was precious blood! 1 Peter 1:18-19 (NKJV) ***“You were not redeemed with corruptible things, like silver or gold, from your aimless conduct received by tradition from your fathers, ¹⁹ but with the precious blood of Christ, as of a lamb without blemish and without spot.”***

The old song say’s “His blood was not just blood of another spotless lamb. His blood was precious blood for it washed the sins of man. His blood heals my body and it sets my Spirit free. I’m so glad His precious blood Still flows from Calvary!”

Forgiveness and reconciliation was made possible because of the blood of the sacrifice that was sprinkled upon the Mercy Seat once a year on the Day of Atonement! **(PLACE A PICTURE OF THE MERCY SEAT ON THE SCREEN AND LEAVE IN PLACE UNTIL THE END OF THE SERVICE)**

The work of the Old Testament High Priest was temporal, he could only provide the assurance that the sins of the people had been rolled ahead for one year, and then it was all to do over again the next year!

The work of the New Testament High Priest (Jesus) is eternal! The only seat in the Holy of Holies was the Mercy Seat and the Priest was not permitted to utilize it because it was the seat of God! Hebrews 10:12-14 (NKJV) *“And every priest stands ministering daily and offering repeatedly the same sacrifices, which can never take away sins. ¹² But this Man, after He had offered one sacrifice for sins forever, sat down at the right hand of God, ¹³ from that time waiting till His enemies are made His footstool. ¹⁴ For by one offering He has perfected forever those who are being sanctified.”*

The overarching principle of the Old Testament was justice without mercy; the resounding message of the New Testament is, mercy trumps justice! Abraham Lincoln said, *“I have always found that mercy bears sweeter fruit than strict justice.”* An old time preacher once told me, *“If you are going to make a mistake, make it on the side of mercy rather than the side of judgment.”*

At the Mercy Seat:

- The wrath of God is appeased...
- Forgiveness of sins is realized...

- God reconciles man to Himself...
- Cleansing of the soul takes place...
- The spirit is brought into alignment with the purposes of God...
- The penalty and punishment for sin is forever canceled...
- A pardon from the God of the universe is handed down...

Jesus is our most merciful High Priest. William Shakespeare said, *“Mercy is nobilities true badge.”*

CONCLUSION:

Because of the sacrifice of the eternal High Priest we are commanded to do three things:

- ***“Let us draw near to God with a sincere heart in full assurance of faith, having our hearts sprinkled to cleanse us from a guilty conscience and having our bodies washed with pure water.”*** (Hebrews 10:22 NIV)
- ***“Let us hold unswervingly to the hope we profess, for he who promised is faithful.”*** (Hebrews 10:23)
- ***“Let us consider how we may spur*** (stimulate and incite) ***one another on***

toward love and good deeds.” (Hebrews 10:24)

This eternal High Priest invites us to draw near to Him, confident in His completed work!

(SONG: COME RUNNING TO THE MERCY SEAT)

II. SYMPATHETIC HIGH PRIEST

The New Testament and especially the book of Hebrews, paints a dramatic portrait of the Lord Jesus as the God-Man who understands us and sympathizes with us. Thirteen times the Gospels mention that Jesus had compassion on an individual or a group of people.

The compassion of this Savior is fully demonstrated in His willingness to become a human being for the purpose of offering Himself a ransom for the sins of mankind. Hebrews 2:9-10 (AMP) ***“But we are able to see Jesus, Who was ranked lower than the angels for a little while, crowned with glory and honor because of His having suffered death, in order that by the grace (unmerited favor) of God [to us sinners] He might experience death for every individual person. 10 For it was an act worthy [of God] and fitting [to the divine***

nature] that He, for Whose sake and by Whom all things have their existence, in bringing many sons into glory, should make the Pioneer of their salvation perfect [should bring to maturity the human experience necessary to be perfectly equipped for His office as High Priest] through suffering.”

Hebrews 2:14-15 (AMP) *”Since, therefore, [these His] children share in flesh and blood [in the physical nature of human beings], He [Himself] in a similar manner partook of the same [nature], that by [going through] death He might bring to nought and make of no effect him who had the power of death--that is, the devil—15 And also that He might deliver and completely set free all those who through the [haunting] fear of death were held in bondage throughout the whole course of their lives.”*

The book of Hebrews is about two things:
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- The High Priest in the new order of religion is none other than Jesus...
- This High Priest is sympathetic to all the passions and problems of His people...

Pretty much everyone gets it that Jesus is a redeeming savior, but most folks completely speed past the fact that He is a sympathetic savior. Hebrews 2:17-18 (AMP) ***"It is evident that it was essential that He be made like His brethren in every respect, in order that He might become a merciful (sympathetic) and faithful High Priest in the things related to God, to make atonement and propitiation for the people's sins. 18For because He Himself [in His humanity] has suffered in being tempted (tested and tried), He is able [immediately] to run to the cry of (assist, relieve) those who are being tempted and tested and tried [and who therefore are being exposed to suffering."*** Notice this, Jesus is: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Merciful...
- Sympathetic...
- Faithful...

These three character traits cause our sympathetic High Priest to: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- RUN to the cry of His people...
- REACT to those who are being tempted...
- RESPOND to those who are being exposed to suffering...

The sympathy of this High Priest is proven in the following way. Jesus made “**propitiation**” for the sins of the human race. The word “**propitiation**” comes from the Greek word “*hilaskomai*.” (Hi-las-comb-i) The use of the word “**propitiation**” is an effort to describe the “*means by which one is satisfied or appeased.*” In this sense Jesus Christ becomes the means by which the righteousness and justice of a Holy God is satisfied.

Therefore Jesus provides the satisfaction demanded by God’s justice whereby the removal of sins is attained! The sympathy of this High Priest is unequalled!

Christ is not only the one who propitiates but also offers Himself as the propitiatory sacrifice. Because of this, He is both the sacrifice and the officiating High Priest!

The reason **this High Priest** is so sympathetic is because He **has faced everything each of us have faced and did so without failure!**

(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL NEXT SLIDE) Hebrews 4:15 (NKJV) “*For we do not have a High Priest who cannot sympathize*

with our weaknesses, but was in all points
tempted as we are, yet without sin.

If Christ is our sympathetic High Priest, we should be His sympathetic people! While speaking to His disciples about His desire for them to take the Gospel of the Kingdom to the lost sheep of the House of Israel, Jesus said, Matthew 10:7-8 (NKJV) “***As you go, preach, saying, ‘The kingdom of heaven is at hand.’⁸ Heal the sick, cleanse the lepers, raise the dead,^[c] cast out demons. Freely you have received, freely give.***”

The desire of this sympathetic High Priest is for His people to become equally sympathetic to the needs of the world and the needs of His Church! Galatians 6:9-11 (NKJV) “***As we have opportunity, let us do good to all, especially to those who are of the household of faith.***”

CONCLUSION:

Because He is our sympathetic High Priest, we can feel comfortable approaching Him with:

(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Every sin we have committed...
- Every mistake we have made...
- Every issue we have developed...

- Every injury we have incurred...

Hebrews 4:14-16 (NKJV) *“Seeing then that we have a great High Priest who has passed through the heavens, Jesus the Son of God, let us hold fast our confession. ¹⁵ For we do not have a High Priest who cannot sympathize with our weaknesses, but was in all points tempted as we are, yet without sin. ¹⁶ Let us therefore come boldly to the throne of grace, that we may obtain mercy and find grace to help in time of need.”*

Because He has been tempted in all things, we do not have to be ashamed as we approach Him with our issues!

III. STRONG HIGH PRIEST

Matthew 28:16-20 (PLACE ONLY THE SCRIPTURE REFERENCE ON THE SCREEN) (NKJV) *“The eleven disciples went away into Galilee, to the mountain which Jesus had appointed for them. ¹⁷ When they saw Him, they worshiped Him; but some doubted. ¹⁸ And Jesus came and spoke to them, saying, “All authority has been given to Me in heaven and on earth.” ¹⁹ Go therefore^[a] and make disciples of all the nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father and of the Son*

and of the Holy Spirit, ²⁰ teaching them to observe all things that I have commanded you; and lo, I am with you always, even to the end of the age.”

This dialogue between Jesus and the Disciples actually occurred between the resurrection and the ascension. Prior to the resurrection He deflected all claims of authority to the Father.

Because of the incarnation of Christ, He voluntarily laid down His God sized ability to assume the restrictions of mere mortals. As a result, every miracle He performed was accomplished not as God, but as a man empowered by the Holy Spirit.

Resurrection morning marked the moment of His transition from being a man to being God!
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- He was no longer bound by time or space...
- He was no longer bound by the restrictions of a mere mortal...
- He was able to appear in various places without the need for transportation...
- He was able to walk through walls without utilizing the doorway...

- He was no longer man; He was now fully God...

As God, He had become the strong High Priest of every believer; as such He could confidently make the claim of possessing “*All power in Heaven and earth.*”

Because He is our strong High Priest we CAN know His strength: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- For every day...
- For every circumstance...
- In every place...

Many of the characters in the book of Hebrews, whom we have come to know as the hero's of the Faith found themselves to be:

- Battle weary...
- Facing rejection...
- Tired of the journey...
- In danger of stumbling...

We tend to place these distinguished Bible characters on a pedestal believing they were super human individuals who never faced discouragement. Let me remind us, they were people who faced the same temptations and

weaknesses that we do! What was the difference maker that catapulted them from the ranks of the ordinary to the extraordinary? They were determined to allow the strength of the strong High Priest to flow through them!

The strong High Priest wanted them to run a strong race and He wants us to do the same! How can we do this?

The only way this can be accomplished is through a clear revelation that our strong High Priest is able to transfer His power into our lives! Acts 1:8 (NKJV) ***“You shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be witnesses to Me in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth.”***

HE IS ABLE TO SAVE US! Hebrews 7:25 (NKJV) ***“He is also able to save to the uttermost those who come to God through Him, since He always lives to make intercession for them.”***

This strong High Priest is able to: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- Save us from our sin...
- Save us from ourselves...

- Save us from this present world...
- Save us from judgment to come...

HE IS ABLE TO DELIVER US! 2 Corinthians 1:8-10 (NKJV) *“For we do not want you to be ignorant, brethren, of our trouble which came to us in Asia: that we were burdened beyond measure, above strength, so that we despaired even of life. ⁹ Yes, we had the sentence of death in ourselves, that we should not trust in ourselves but in God who raises the dead, ¹⁰ who delivered us from so great a death, and does deliver us; in whom we trust that He will still deliver us.”*

This strong High Priest:

- Hath delivered...
- Doth deliver...
- Will yet deliver...

This strong High Priest:

- Delivered Lot from Sodom...
- Delivered Israel from Egypt...
- Delivered Jericho into the hand of Joshua, despite the walls that were thought to be surer than the noonday sun...
- Delivered David from the bear, the lion, and the giant...

- Delivered Daniel from the jaws of the starving lions...
- Delivered thousands from hunger pains by multiplying the loaves and fishes...
- Delivered Paul from shipwreck, beatings, jail sentences, and the venom of a poisonous snake...
- Delivered John the Revelator from boiling oil and the rocky barren island of Patmos...

Strength is about hope and one of the most significant things this strong High Priest deposits in our lives is hope. Christopher Reeve said, *"Once you choose hope, anything's possible."*

We must remember, He is no respecter of persons, what he has done for others He is perfectly able and willing to do for us!

HE IS ABLE TO KEEP US! Jude 1:24

(NKJV) ***"Now to Him who is able to keep you from stumbling, And to present you faultless Before the presence of His glory with exceeding joy."***

Notice the word ***"stumbling"*** in this verse. Jude states that this strong High Priest is able

“to keep us from stumbling!” We all know our own weaknesses and we often attempt to mask those flaws with all kinds of window dressing.

Our strong High Priest does not want believers to be relegated to window dressing in an effort to deal with our weaknesses. It is His desire for each believer to allow His power to permeate our lives so that our weaknesses become victories!

Winston Churchill said, *“Kites rise highest against the wind, not with it.”*

Before the resurrection, every Disciple whom Jesus had chosen forsook Him and fled, but after the resurrection and ascension they became lean, mean, fighting machines! When their strong High Priest empowered them and interceded for them everything changed!

The first century Church was full of people who went the distance in spite of the odds. Look at the perseverance of the twelve disciples:
(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)

- Andrew died on a cross...
- Simon was crucified...
- Bartholomew was flayed alive...

- James the son of Zebedee was beheaded...
- James the son of Alphaeus was beaten to death...
- Thomas was run through with a lance...
- Mathias was stoned and then beheaded...
- Matthew was slain by the sword...
- Peter was crucified upside down...
- Thaddeus was shot to death with arrows...
- Philip was hanged...
- Only John made it through alive but he was boiled in oil and exiled to a small island in the middle of the Mediterranean Sea...

Winston Churchill said, *“If you’re going through hell, keep going!”*

CONCLUSION:

When we feel weak and vulnerable, and we all do from time to time, we must remember that our strong High Priest is able to get the victory for us! He is not only able He is willing! He is at least as willing as He is able!

Isaiah 40:28-31 (NKJV) ***“The everlasting God, the LORD, The Creator of the ends of the earth, Neither faints nor is weary. His***

understanding is unsearchable. ²⁹ He gives power to the weak, And to those who have no might He increases strength. ³⁰ Even the youths shall faint and be weary, And the young men shall utterly fall, ³¹ But those who wait on the LORD Shall renew their strength; They shall mount up with wings like eagles, They shall run and not be weary, They shall walk and not faint.”

IV. SOVEREIGN HIGH PRIEST

Hebrews 7:23-28 (NKJV) “There were many priests, but they were prevented by death from continuing. ²⁴ But He, because He continues forever, has an unchangeable priesthood. ²⁵ Therefore He is also able to save to the uttermost those who come to God through Him, since He always lives to make intercession for them. ²⁶ For such a High Priest was fitting for us, who is holy, harmless, undefiled, separate from sinners, and has become higher than the heavens; ²⁷ who does not need daily, as those high priests, to offer up sacrifices, first for His own sins and then for the people’s, for this He did once for all when He offered up Himself. ²⁸ For the law appoints as high priests men who have weakness, but the word of the oath, which

came after the law, appoints the Son who has been perfected forever.”

The word **sovereign** means “*one that exercises supreme authority.*” One that is sovereign has no peers and trumps everything and everyone else.

Our text makes the following distinctions between an earthly priest and the Sovereign High Priest:

1) “*There were many priests, but they were prevented by death from continuing. 24 But He, because He continues forever. He has an unchangeable priesthood.*”

Earthly priests come and go because they have a shelf life punctuated by a thing called death. Hebrews 9:27 (NKJV) “*It is appointed for men to die once, but after this the judgment*”

An earthly priest lives from seventy to one hundred years and cannot continue because they have an appointment with death. Job 14:5 (NKJV) “*Our days are determined, The number of our months are with You; You have appointed our limits, so that we cannot pass.*”

The difference between an earthly priest and the Sovereign High Priest is that the earthly priest dies and never returns, but [this Sovereign High Priest died and has been raised for an eternal day!](#)

2) **“He has an unchangeable priesthood.”**

Earthly priests change:

- Physically...
- Spiritually...
- Relationally...
- Theologically...
- Philosophically...

Though earthly priest may change, [this Sovereign High Priest will never change!](#)

Hebrews 13:8 (NKJV) ***“Jesus Christ is the same yesterday, today, and forever.”***

3) ***“Therefore He is also able to save to the uttermost those who come to God through Him.”***

The very best an earthly priest can hope to do is to offer sacrifices and prayers on behalf of others. [This Sovereign High Priest has the ability to save!](#) He is the savior!

He is not only the savior; ***“He is also able to save to the uttermost those who come to God through Him.”***

4) ***“He always lives to make intercession for them.”***

At there very best, Earthly Priests have a life of their own and cannot devote their undivided attention to the needs of others.

Earthly priests must sleep from time to time and see to their own human interests. This Sovereign High Priest is at His post of duty:

- Twenty-four hours a day...
- Seven days a week...
- Three hundred sixty five days a year...
- Three hundred sixty six days on leap year...

Psalm 121:4 (NKJV) ***“Behold, He who keeps Israel Shall neither slumber nor sleep.”***

This Sovereign High Priest never ceases to pray for us!

5) ***“For such a High Priest was fitting for us, who is holy, harmless, undefiled, separate***

from sinners, and has become higher than the heavens.”

Earthly priests can practice righteous lives but they are not:

- Holy...
- Harmless...
- undefiled...
- Sinless...
- Exalted to a celestial being...

This Sovereign High Priest is:

- Holy... (Sinless life)
- Harmless... (Never mishandled one person)
- Undefiled... (All points tempted)
- Assumed a sinful form and turned it sinless...
- Transitioned back into an eternal God...

This Sovereign High Priest is the exact representation of the Father!

6) **“Who does not need daily, as those high priests, to offer up sacrifices, first for His own sins and then for the people’s”**

Earthly priests must offer sacrifices for their own sin before they can offer a sacrifice for the sins of others.

This Sovereign High Priest has never experience the need to make Himself worthy of stepping into a priestly role on behalf of others!

7) “***This He did once for all** when He offered up Himself.*”

The work of an earthly priest is never done because the priest himself continues to sin, and so does every other person he serves. Talk about job security!

This Sovereign High Priest offered one sacrifice for sin and sat down at the right hand of the Father in a place of authority!

8) “***The law appoints as high priests men who have weakness, but the word of the oath, which came after the law, appoints the Son who has been perfected forever.***”

Earthly priests are certainly weak and full of faults, but this Sovereign High Priest is a strong, faultless High Priest **(LEAVE ON THE SCREEN UNTIL THE NEXT SLID)**

“Who has been perfected forever.” This is only possible if He is the Sovereign High Priest!

One of the remarkable features of the book of Hebrews is that from the opening verse to the closing statement, we see a beautiful picture of Jesus as the Sovereign High Priest. Hebrews 1:2 (NKJV) ***“In these last days God has spoken to us by His Son, whom He has appointed heir of all things, through whom also He made the world.”*** Hebrews 13:20-21 (NKJV) ***“Now may the God of peace who brought up our Lord Jesus from the dead, that great Shepherd of the sheep, through the blood of the everlasting covenant,* ²¹ ***make you complete in every good work to do His will, working in you what is well pleasing in His sight, through Jesus Christ, to whom be glory forever and ever. Amen.*”****

The Portrait of Christ painted by the writer of the book of Hebrews is one that:

- Defies human logic...
- Staggers the imagination...
- Spans time and eternity...

This brings us face to face with the reality of a crucified savior who has become the Sovereign High Priest! As Sovereign High Priest:

- He is God...
- He is the first and last...
- He is the beginning and the ending...
- He is the keeper of creation and the creator of all...
- He is the architect of the universe and the manager of all times...
- He always was, He always is, and He always will be...
- He is unmoved, unchanged, undefeated, and never undone...

As Sovereign High Priest:

- He was bruised and brought healing...
- He was pierced and eased the pain of the human race...
- He was persecuted and brought freedom...
- He was dead and brought life...
- He is risen and brings power...
- He reigns and brings Peace...

Think of this:

- The world can't understand Him...
- Armies can't defeat Him...

- The schools can't explain Him...
- Leaders can't ignore Him...
- Herod couldn't kill Him...
- The Pharisees couldn't confuse Him...
- The people couldn't hold Him...
- Nero couldn't crush Him...
- Hitler couldn't silence Him...
- Osama couldn't erase Him...
- New age can't replace Him...
- Oprah can't explain Him away...

As Sovereign High Priest:

-
- He is gentle...
- He is good...
- He is kind...
- He is light...
- He is love...
- He is Lord...

Because He is sovereign, He is God! As God:

- He is holy...
- He is mighty...
- He is powerful...
- He is pure...

- He is righteous...

Let us never forget:

- His Word is eternal...
- His ways are right...
- His intentions are good...
- His will is unchanging...
- His mind is on us...

I declare to you:

- He is my comfort...
- He is my guide...
- He is my joy...
- He is my peace...
- He is my Lord...
- He is my Savior...
- He rules my life...

I serve Him because:

- His bond is love...
- His burden is light...
- His goal for me is abundant life...

I follow Him because:

- He is the wisdom of the wise...
- He is the power of the powerful...
- He is the ancient of days...
- He is the ruler of rulers...

- He is the leader of leaders...
- He is the overseer of the over-comers...
- His goal is a relationship with ME!

His covenant with me declares:

- He will never leave me...
- He will never forsake me...
- He will never mislead me...
- He will never forget me...
- He will never overlook me...
- He will never cancel my appointment in His appointment book...

This I know about Him

- When I fall, He will lift me up...
- When I fail, He will forgive me...
- When I am weak, He will be strong...
- When I am lost, He will show me the way...
- When I am afraid, He will be my courage...
- When I stumble, He will steady me...
- When I am injured, He will heal me...
- When I am broken, He will mend me...
- When I am blinded, He will show me the way...
- When I am hungry, He will feed me...
- When I face trials, He will be with me...

- When I face persecution, He will shield me...
- When I experience grief, He will comfort me...
- When I face loss, He will provide for me...
- When I face death, He will carry me home...

He is:

- Everything for everybody...
- Everywhere, every time, in every way...

He is God and that means He is faithful! I am His, and He is mine!

As Sovereign High Priest, He is my father in heaven and I declare to you that He can whip the father of this world!

CONCLUSION:

I am secure because He is: **(PLACE ON THE SCREEN ONE AT A TIME)**

- My Sacrificial High Priest...
- My Sympathetic High Priest...
- My Strong High Priest...
- My Sovereign High Priest...